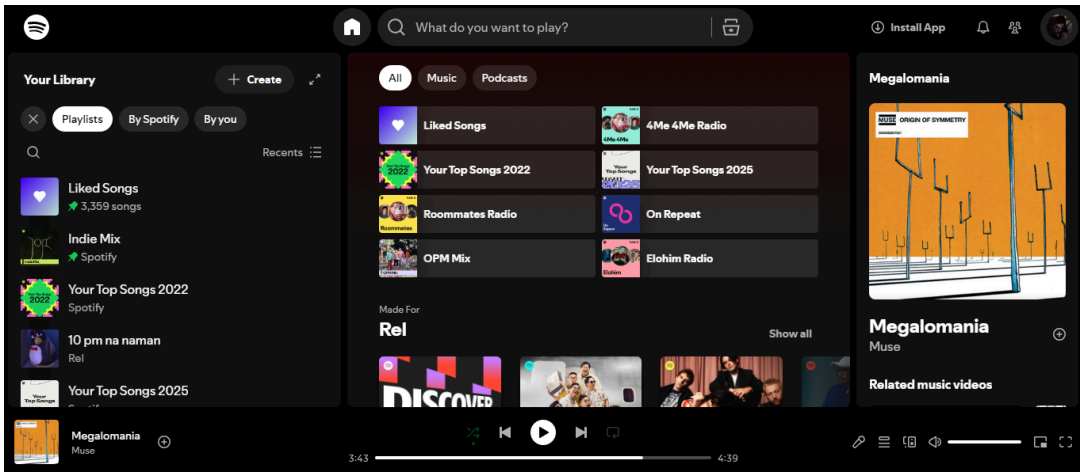
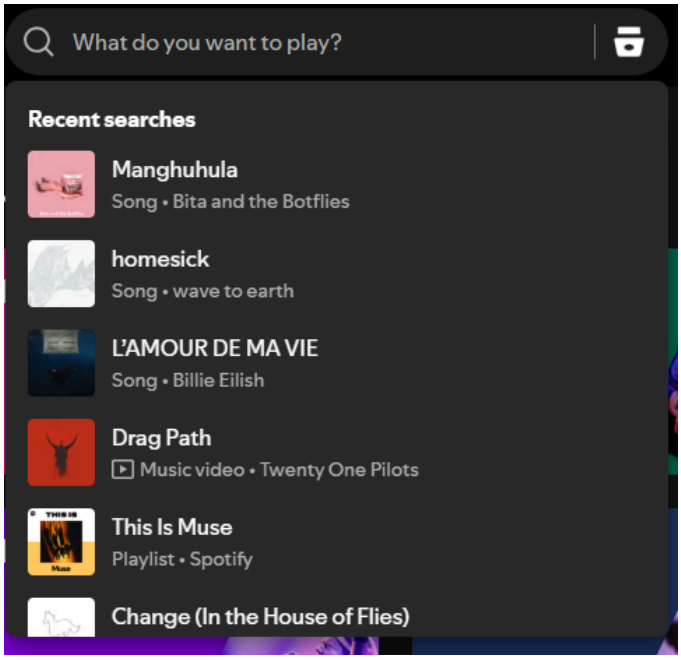
1. Observation & Analysis

Spotify's web interface is a "Single Page Application" (SPA), which means it doesn't refresh like a traditional website. This creates a very smooth experience for most users but can be a nightmare for screen readers if "focus" isn't managed correctly. My analysis shows that Spotify has made massive strides in recent years by introducing dedicated **keyboard shortcuts** and high-contrast modes. However, the interface is still quite "dense." For a student researcher or developer, the complexity of nested menus (like "More" buttons on every track) can feel like a maze without proper assistive tools.

2. System Screenshot Samples





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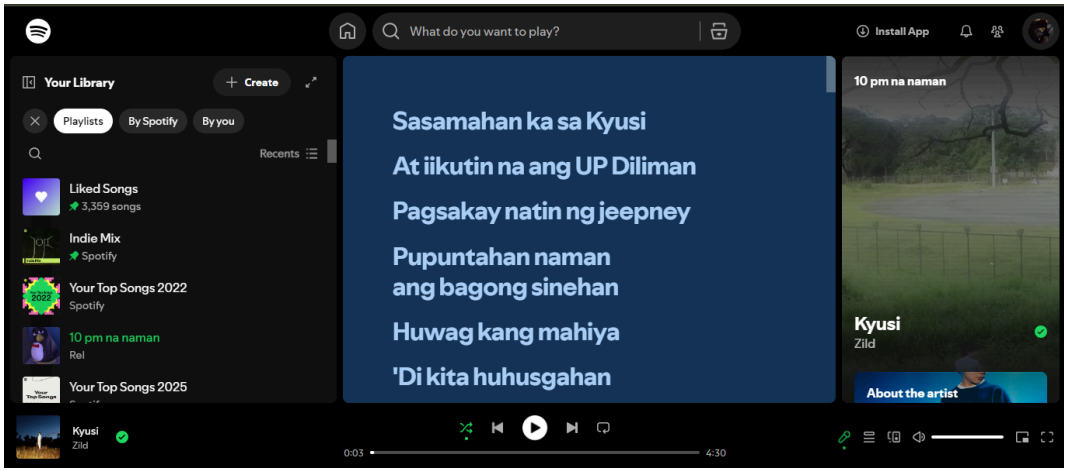

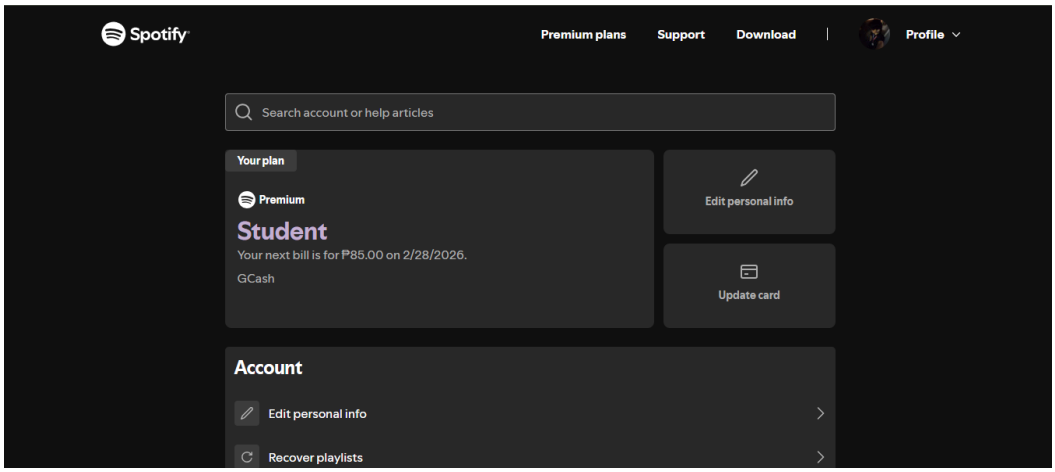

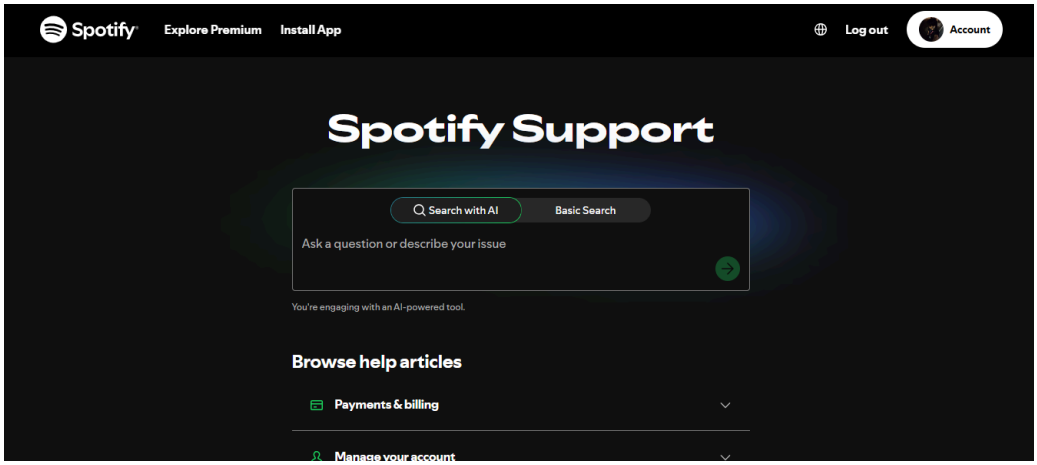

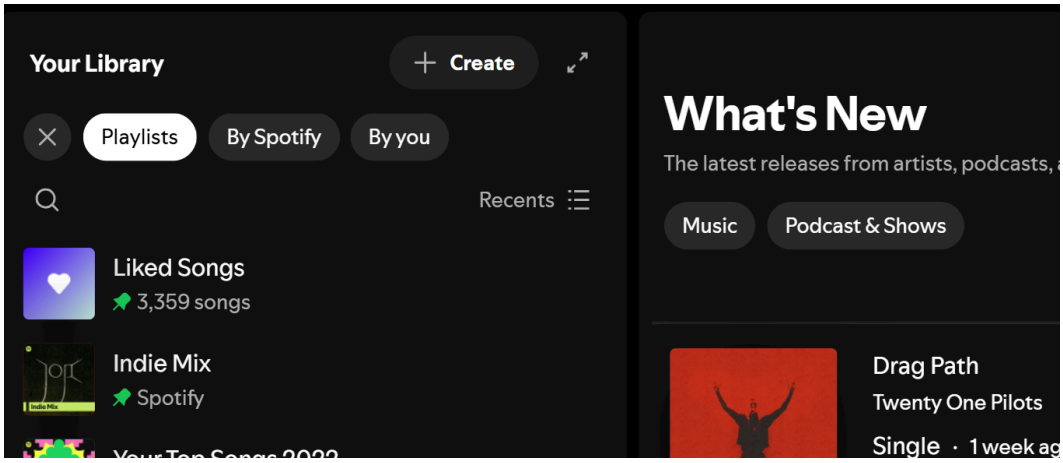

3. Accessibility Evaluation

1. Visual Impairment (Perceivable Principle)

Alt Text: Album art is usually treated as "informative" or "decorative." In search results, Spotify generally provides the artist and album name as text nearby, though some dynamic banners still lack descriptive alt text.

Text Resizing: The web player supports standard browser zooming. However, at high zoom levels (250%+), the sidebar often collapses into icons, which may be confusing for users who rely on text labels.

Color Contrast: Spotify is famous for its "Dark Mode." While aesthetically pleasing, the dark gray on black text (#B3B3B3 on #121212) sometimes falls below the 4.5:1 contrast ratio.

Heading Structure: The site uses <h1> for playlist titles and <h2> for sections like "Made For You," making it easy for screen reader users to jump to specific content.

2. Hearing Impairment (Perceivable Principle)

Captions/Transcripts: Spotify has integrated **real-time lyrics** for millions of songs, which serves as a functional transcript for the hearing impaired.

Visual Alerts: When you "Like" a song, a small green heart and a temporary visual toast message appear, ensuring the user doesn't need to hear a sound to know the action was successful.

3. Motor Disabilities (Operable Principle)

Keyboard Navigation: This is where Spotify shines. They have a dedicated "Keyboard Shortcuts" menu (accessible via Shift + ?). You can play/pause with Space, skip tracks, and even search using only the keyboard.

Button Sizes: Most buttons (Play, Next, Volume) are large enough to be easily clicked. However, the "three-dot" menu icon on individual songs is quite small and requires precise mouse movement.

Drag-and-Drop: Adding songs to a playlist often uses drag-and-drop, but Spotify provides an "Add to playlist" option in the right-click menu as an accessible alternative.

Time Limits: There are no time-sensitive tasks, which is ideal for users with motor or cognitive delays.

4. Cognitive Disabilities (Understandable Principle)

Clarity of Language: The navigation is very intuitive (Home, Search, Your Library).

Consistent Navigation: The "Now Playing" bar is pinned to the bottom of the screen regardless of where you navigate, providing a constant sense of control.

Error Messages: If the internet cuts out, a clear "No internet connection" banner appears at the top.

Pop-ups/Distractions: For "Free" users, audio and visual ads can be a major cognitive distraction. For "Premium" users, the experience is much cleaner and focused.